

5.3 Download Managers

A download manager is a must-have Internet tool if you're on a modem connection. Even for broadband users, it can be handy, as one never knows what can happen on the server side of the connection—and you don't want to waste your precious broadband connection downloading the same thing twice or more.

Download managers let you download files from a server in parts. They often work at the maximum available bandwidth, thus reducing the time taken for the download. They keep track of how much data has been downloaded, and if the download breaks, they restart from where the download broke.

Like with most things related to the Internet, choices are aplenty, and finding the right one can be quite a task!

Fresh Download 7.36

Fresh Download Manager is one the most versatile and easy-to-use download managers. Installation is simple, and the interface is intuitive. It integrates with your default browser, and other browsers can be added just as easily.

A download doesn't have any limitations, but you can set up your own set of choices for what files are to be associated with a program. For example, when you click on an image while browsing, some download managers save it to the default folder. In Fresh Download, though, you can disable that so the picture is displayed in the browser only. What's more, this comes as freeware, so no annoying ad banners or sharing of bandwidth resources is required. Important buttons such as 'Add' and 'Options' are easy to locate, and even inside submenus, it's relatively easy to locate certain items, which are otherwise hard to locate in other, similar software we tested.

One of the more impressive feature of Fresh Download is the ability to accelerate downloads using both the FTP and HTTP protocols, pause-and-resume capability, recovery from dropped con-